

Wang Zihao

Undergraduate Student in Psychology (Qiushi Honor's Program), Zhejiang University
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INTERESTS

Topics: mental imagery and aphantasia; consciousness (self-model; absence); cognitive neuroscience.

Methods: behavioural psychophysics; fMRI, EEG and fNIRS; eye-tracking; experimental programming (Python, PsychoPy; learning MATLAB, SPM).

EDUCATION

09/2025 – 06/2029
(Expected)

Zhejiang University — B.Sc. in Psychology (Qiushi Honor's Program)

Hangzhou, China

Research mentors: Dr. Yuzheng Hu (Department of Psychology and Behavioral Sciences) and Dr. Dian Lyu (MOE Frontier Science Center for Brain Science and Brain-Machine Integration)

- GPA: 3.95/4.3 (Top 2 in Honor's Program); English: IELTS 8.0
- Selected coursework: Research Techniques in Psychology; Language, Mind and Brain; Probability and Mathematical Statistics; Calculus; Linear Algebra; Programming; Ethics and Philosophy of Artificial Intelligence

01/2026 – 02/2026

University of Oxford — Oxford Prospects Winter Visit

Psychology: Interdisciplinary Frontiers of Behaviour and Mind in the Age of AI · grade A+

- Awarded the Best Presentation Award and the Best Film Award

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2026 – 2028

Undergraduate Researcher — Visual mental imagery and aphantasia

PIs: Dr. Jianghao Liu, Ph.D. (Paris Brain Institute, ICM)

- **Research question:** whether imagery signals in aphantasia fail to be generated, or are generated but fail to reach conscious access — a distinction the existing literature has not resolved.
- **Design and methods:** co-designed the study; the protocol combines a near-threshold perceptual detection task with an imagery task, together with electrophysiological and neuromodulation measures of visual-cortical and prefrontal involvement.
- **Role:** built the experimental platform at Zhejiang University and am responsible for participant recruitment, data collection and quality control.

01/2026 – Present

Research Assistant — Brain plasticity following spinal-cord-stimulation therapy

PI: Dr. Dian Lyu, Ph.D. · Liangzhu Laboratory, Zhejiang University

- **Research question:** how the motor cortex reorganizes during BCI-mediated recovery, studied in individuals who regained motor function after spinal cord stimulation.
- **Stimulus development:** helped refine the experimental paradigm and independently transformed raw stimulus materials into finalized stimuli through video editing and systematic formatting.
- **Data acquisition:** assisted with fMRI data collection and optimized the PsychoPy program for reliable stimulus presentation.

RESEARCH TRAINING

- **Laboratory rotations:** rotated across social, clinical, developmental and cognitive neuroscience labs, progressively focusing on cognitive neuroscience as a pathway to the study of consciousness.
- **Reading groups and seminars:** Consciousness Science Reading Group (Swarma Club); Interdisciplinary Reading Club of Aphantasia (IRCA); philosophy-of-mind seminars and national academic conferences.

SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

- 12/2025 – 04/2026 **Lead Organizer & Initiator — Psychology Outreach Series, 2050@2026 Global Youth Gathering**
Hangzhou, China
- Designed and delivered the keynote *Where Is the Mind?* to translate psychological insights for a cross-disciplinary audience; organized and moderated the *This Is Psychology* forum (recruited three peer speakers and co-presented); and facilitated the *The Psych Crew Assembles* roundtable.
 - Coordinated three experiential sessions (nature therapy, movement therapy and an interactive exhibition), managing practitioner invitations, participant logistics and on-site support.
- 06/2026 – Present **Founder and Coordinator — Consciousness Observers (CO-LAB)**
Zhejiang University
- Founded an interdisciplinary consciousness-research group spanning several departments; designed and maintain its website; convened its first event in the Department of Psychology.
- 2026 – 2027 **Peer Mentor Group Leader**, Qiushi Psychology Science Class & Brain-Machine Intelligence Innovation Class, Zhejiang University
- 2026 – Present **Class Monitor**, Psychology (Qiushi Science Class) 2501, Chu Kochen Honors College, Zhejiang University
- Aug – Sep 2026 **Volunteer**, Sino-European International Conference on Human Cognition and Artificial Intelligence
- 03/2026, 09/2026 **High-school science outreach**, Hangzhou No. 2 High School; Yuqian High School, Lin'an

HONORS & AWARDS

Research Awards

- 08/2026 First Prize (large-project workshop), *“Mind Science and Intelligent Future”* International Summer School for Top Students in Psychology — Ministry of Education Psychology Teaching Steering Committee & Faculty of Psychology, Beijing Normal University
- 03/2026 Excellent Poster Award, Psychology (Honor's Program) Research Exhibition, Zhejiang University
- 02/2026 Best Presentation Award & Best Film Award, Oxford Prospects Winter Visit

Other Honors

- 04/2025 Best Debater & Best Team, Design Intelligence Award (DIA) Debate Competition

REFERENCES

Available upon request.